



NEWSLETTER

Michaelmas 2023

Dear Readers,

The AFC newsletter is back! We hope to brighten up your winter with this all-new digital format that celebrates the society's recent progress with some fantastic contributions from its members. Prepare yourself for a thrilling deep-dive into an ivory artefact connected to Napoleon (guaranteed to be more gripping than the recent film), ancient wisdoms from the Earth Mother herself, and Mia's (equally wise) insights into why archaeology today is plagued with "too many scapes" - plus poems, art & more.

First, I want to thank those who contributed things to fill up 15 pages (!) of this edition. Also a huge thanks to everyone who came along to any of our events this term - you're a big part of making archaeology a community as well as an academic discipline.

We hope that you had a nice term and are now enjoying a lovely holiday. Don't forget to come back with lots of exciting articles for our Lent edition!

Lots of love,

Hannah + Mia

If you have any questions/comments/threats/submissions, get in touch with the Editorial Committee (Hannah, hc581). Please note this is intended for circulation within the society only

NEW STASH 2

Events!Events!Events!Events!

get it here

COMING SOON:

- Return of our annual feast :o Join us for a talk from a soon-to-be-revealed illustrious speaker (hint: this year's theme will be "current research in the archaeology and deep history of Africa") followed by a drinks reception and dinner at Lucy Cavendish college - tickets to be released soon.

+ more exciting speakers throughout term...



FOOTBALL REPORT

Dec 26 was a day to go down in the history books as we played the ASNACs for the first time at football. With a few reinforcements we beat our biggest rivals 4-0!

Practices are weekly at Queens Backs. We're changing the time (so it doesn't clash with 1st year practicals), keep an eye on the socials.. Bring dry socks, it's very boggy! As it gets colder we may retreat to the pub afterwards to warm up...

- A weekend swap with the Oxford archaeology society is in the works

- The ASNACs will inevitably want a rematch after being crushed in the first AFC/ASNAC football match at the end of Michaelmas

- As soon as the weather is warmer, Alastair Key has promised to run a flint-knapping session with a few of his PhD students

+ more pub nights, craft socials, quizzes etc - look out for our termcard at the start of next term.



Evan's object of the term

Did you, like me, recently go to watch Ridley Scott's Napoleon? Were you, like me, incredibly disappointed with the historical accuracy of the film but more importantly also quite bored by the film's abysmal script and poor acting? Did you perhaps think that we can get a much more interesting sense of Napoleon's times and society's ongoing fascination with the man through material culture? Then I've got just the thing for you.



I was wandering around the World Museum in Liverpool the other day, and this was perhaps the most interesting object that caught my eye. It's an ivory card case decorated with a view of Napoleon's tomb on St Helena, produced after his death in 1821 and probably before 1840. There are other similar card cases which show Napoleon's house on the island. Most interestingly, the card case was produced by Chinese artists in Canton (Guangdong) in southern China. Clearly,

images of Napoleon's tomb had travelled across to China and these were then copied by artists there. For example, the watercolour below from 1833 similarly shows the tomb in a small grove surrounded by a fence. I find it interesting how these Chinese artists would have then sold this back into Europe for people to use and so how European cultural trends had a symbiotic relationship with production methods in the far east. For me, this foreshadows the outsourcing of manufacturing industries to China in the 20th Century. This object is right on the cusp of big changes in China in terms of its relationship with the west. The First Opium War (1839-1842) culminated in the Treaty of Nanjing ceding Hong Kong to Britain in 1842. It is likely that the object was produced just before then. Therefore, I think it is interesting in the way it encapsulates global trade (I imagine the ivory probably came from South Asia) and colonialism from a cultural perspective. Surely this is a more interesting product of Napoleon-mania than Ridley Scott's film?



VOLUNTEERS NEEDED

Would you like the opportunity to use replica giant Palaeolithic handaxes and contribute to research on these exceptional tools? Participation involves experimental tasks meant to replicate butchery tasks using replica handaxes (no carcasses!). For more information please contact Malaika Standley Barrow: mms85@cam.ac.uk, I am happy to answer any questions or provide more information/ links to find out more about these tools!



Unearthed

Poem & illustration by Izzy Bunting

With our trowels we turn the dry earth
And with bare hands, dusted and
Raw with stone, resurrect: pig jaw,
Deer bone and pot sherd and tooth.

Past emerges in the present.
Press my ear against the old floor
And I can almost hear it:
Footsteps and fire, your song low
As you string fish bone onto twine,
Into time, one or two lost in
Mist rising from the Danube.
How strange, for the bead you once held
To rest here now on my palm.



NEWS FROM ABROAD

CUBAS

Despite the radio silence from CUBAS this past Michaelmas, rumours of our death have been greatly exaggerated. Following on from the seminars hosted in 2022-23 (all of which are still available on our YouTube channel), the society has undergone some committal and organisational changes this past Michaelmas term. Please do sign up to our mailing list as we very much hope we are able to bring everyone some events in 2024!

~ Thomas Prince (CUBAS secretary)

Cambridge Classics Soc

If you love Greek myths or want to find out more about what the Romans ever did for us, the Classics Society is for you!

The Cambridge University Classics Society was established in 1950 with Elizabeth Wace as the first president (daughter of the famous Mycenae archaeologist Prof. Alan Wace, who became herself a leading archaeologist of the Aegean Bronze Age) and has evolved a lot over the years, falling dormant over Covid. We have recently revived the society and are planning a fantastic termcard of events for Lent and beyond, including film nights, speaker events, toga parties and more!

We recently hosted a Saturnalia-themed party in the Museum of Classical Archaeology which was great fun - we may have seen you there! If not, follow our instagram at @camclassicsoc to keep up to date on what's coming up soon.

Anyone who is interested in Ancient Greece or Rome is welcome, regardless of your degree!

~ Elizabeth Eaton-Banks (Classics Soc publicity officer)

PUMPKINS (and squashes)

amongst other masterpieces (not pictured): a statue from Lepenski Vir, the Lion Man (winner!!) & a lovely Nazca spider



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Hannah Curry

After several hours trawling through faded envelopes and illegible fountain pen, I have emerged from the AFC archives with a revelation - we missed our 75th anniversary! In an attempt to make up for this somehow, here's a very rushed summary of a few of the highlights from the collection:

The society was officially founded in 1947, when its first constitution was written. However, before this, it was known as the "Retrospectors' Club." The committee included Haddon and Lethbridge (based on the single termcard I could find).

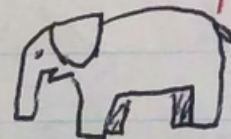
The famed election of 1961-2, where Renfrew lost to Cunliffe, is there on paper (pictured below). Mellars also failed to gain a position in the same event... perhaps a lucky escape?

In 1976, following a Feast at Medwards (then New Hall) with "plenty of booze," "Matthew Spriggs was disgustingly ill in the cycle sheds."

CAMBRIDGE ARCHAEOLOGICAL FIELD CLUB

ELECTION OF OFFICERS 1961 - 62

FOR PRESIDENT ①	Miss J. Aitken.	8	11	10	} Redistrib. Once.
	Mr. B. Cunliffe.	21	111	24	
	Mr. J.G. Nandris	5			
	Mr. A.C. Renfrew	12		12	
FOR SECRETARY	Miss J. Aitken	24			} Cunliffe's votes redistributed: Absolute majority
	Mr. B. Cunliffe				
	Mr. C. Higham	7			
	Mr. A.C. Renfrew	14			
FOR COMMITTEE (4 vacancies) ④	Mr. S. Antoniou			7	
	Mr. G. Brown.			20	
	Mr. D.M. Collins			18	
	Miss F.M. Davies			27	
	Miss M. Evans			16	
	Mr. C. Higham			24	
	Mr. P. Mellars			15	
	Mr. J.G. Nandris			26	
	Mr. R. Oakley			12	
	Mr. D. Orr			8	



Corpus
Cais
Corpus
Peterh
Trinity
Christ
Candle
Fulb
Mr. Ch
Trini

G. Wilkinson New

A gorgeous stamp & part of an envelope from a correspondent in Kenya are pictured (they sadly declined to speak at Cambridge on account of not having Zoom in the 60s).

Finally, from our first ever newsletter (1986), the advice column pictured below...

Here's to another 75 years of the AFC - may we continue to amuse future archaeologists :-)



PAR AVION
AEROGRAMME



YOUNG WARTHOG

EARTH MOTHER

Dear Earth Mother,

I've been struggling for many years now, but I've finally had to face up to the fact that my trowel is bent. Am I a freak?

Val Doonican fan, York.

- * I was pleased that you had the courage to
- * ask for help. At the moment you are suffering from the common "circuitous trowel syndrome" which confronts many diggers at some stage in their careers; your openness has probably saved you from the more damaging "acute shovel dementure" which leads to whole excavations going round in circles, with no firm conclusions ever being reached. I suggest you contact your nearest branch of Bent Tools Anonymous.



Dear Earth Mother,

I'm in love with Colin Renfrew and I just don't know what to do about it. I've got loads of his pictures stuck on my walls and I buy all his books. I think about him all the time and cry myself to sleep at night because I want to meet him so much. My friends say I'm silly to get so worked up about a dream but I think it might come true one day. What can I do?

farming fan, Oxford.

- * Your friends are right. This is just a dream and you're only doing
- * harm to yourself by letting yourself get so caught up in it. It's perfectly healthy to have a crush on a famous archaeologist - we all have crushes on idols at some time - but it becomes unhealthy when you're obsessed. Deep down you must know that you'll probably never meet this man and even if you did, you'd probably be disappointed as underneath all the initial glamour, you'd find he was just like all the other real live boys you're avoiding at the moment. So why torture yourself by fretting over him all the time? It would be far more productive if you went out and met some real live archaeologists...

The view from Empúries
Ed Suckling

Two thousand year old eyes
Burning in the Mediterranean sun

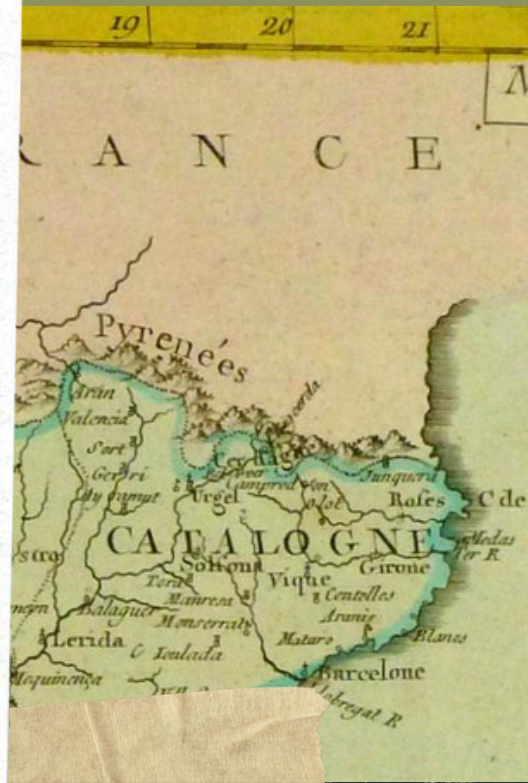
A piney waft spindles into our sandy skin
Salt crystals flaking from dry hair

A wave crash finds her way into our ears
Impossible skies looking down on us

City dust gathering between our toes
Tender soles sore from a red-hot beach

Coarse gravel sticking to our shins
Cuts upon our feet as we hobble home

Old father stringing cups together
Two ghosts tighten the cord



DOGS ON DIGS

The 'posthuman turn' aims to give non-humans more agency in narratives of the past...

here are some of our favourite agents taking action on recent digs :)



Nova kept Mia company as she spent her 4 weeks at the CAU in bed with tonsillitis



^ Ed with Simon's renowned Irish Water Spaniels (in Italy, of course)



John is not an archaeologist, but he is from Greece.

<- Eska  inspecting the spoil heap at Harpham (Yorkshire) last year



Against scapes: subjective experience and an interconnected world

Mia Perry

Landscapes, taskscapes (Ingold), soundscapes, smellscapes, deathscapes, childscapes, heritagescapes, tinscapes, bogscapes. A current trend in archaeological literature is the adding of the suffix 'scape' to a word. This addition of a 'scape' can be used to create several arguments: the spatial and temporal distribution of said word in a landscape, the experience of the word in a given space, and/or the relationship of the word within its physical and metaphorical context. But I believe that the idea of a 'scape' has been overused. I'm not arguing that the idea of scapes should be voided per se, it is a useful tool in trying to synthesise interesting theories about the past and provides a more complex viewpoint when illustrating a 'landscape of X'. Instead, I am arguing that we should be more careful when creating scapes thinking about their implications in reconstructing the past as scape encapsulates more elements and experiences than what meets the eye.

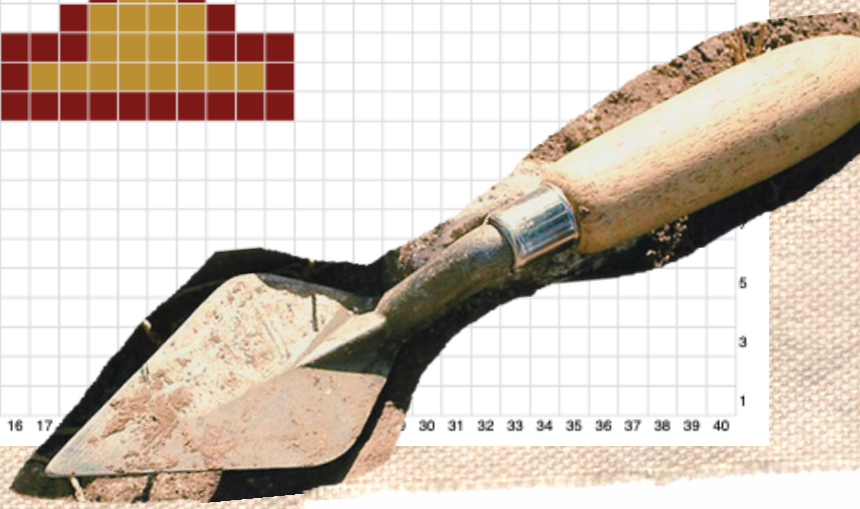
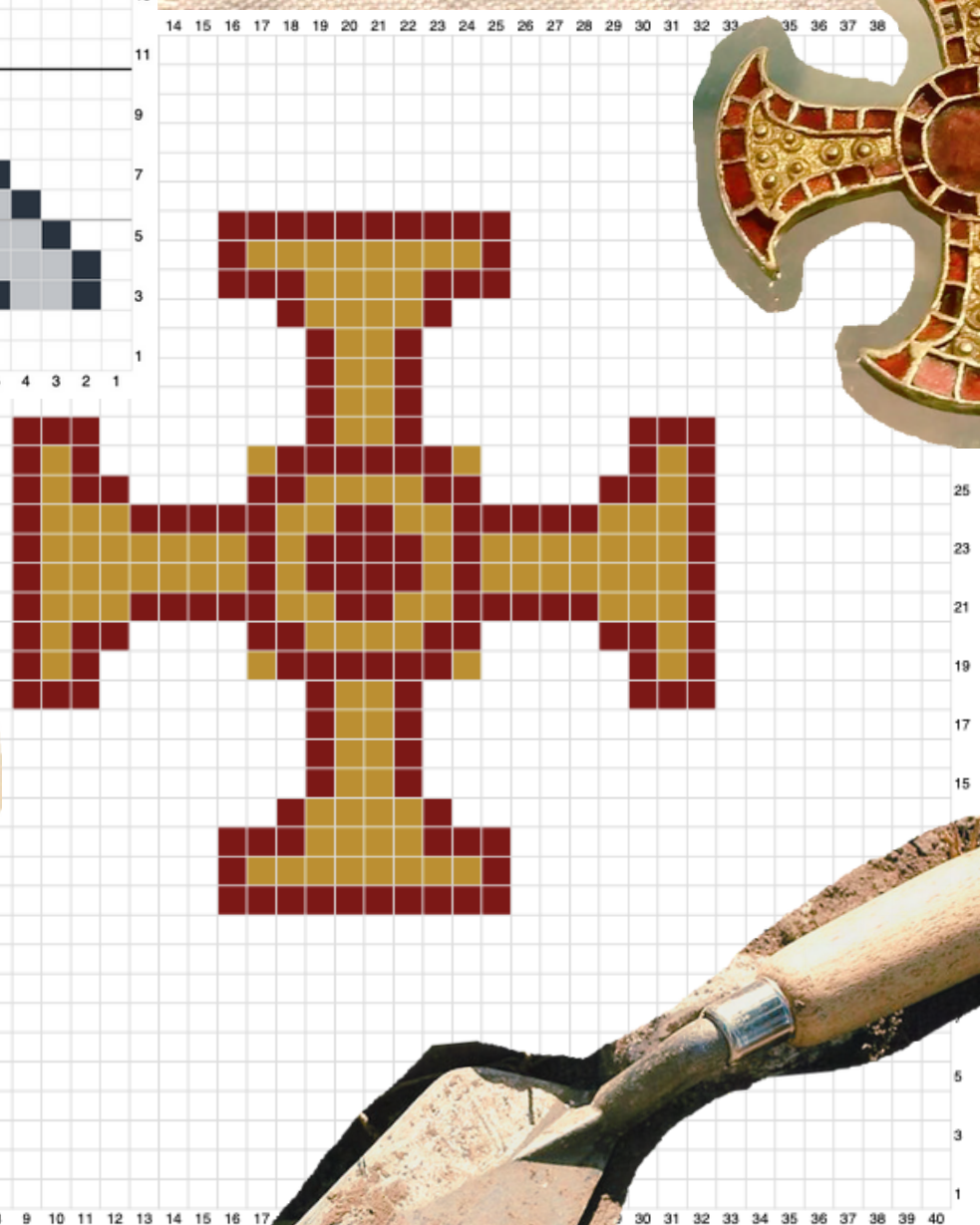
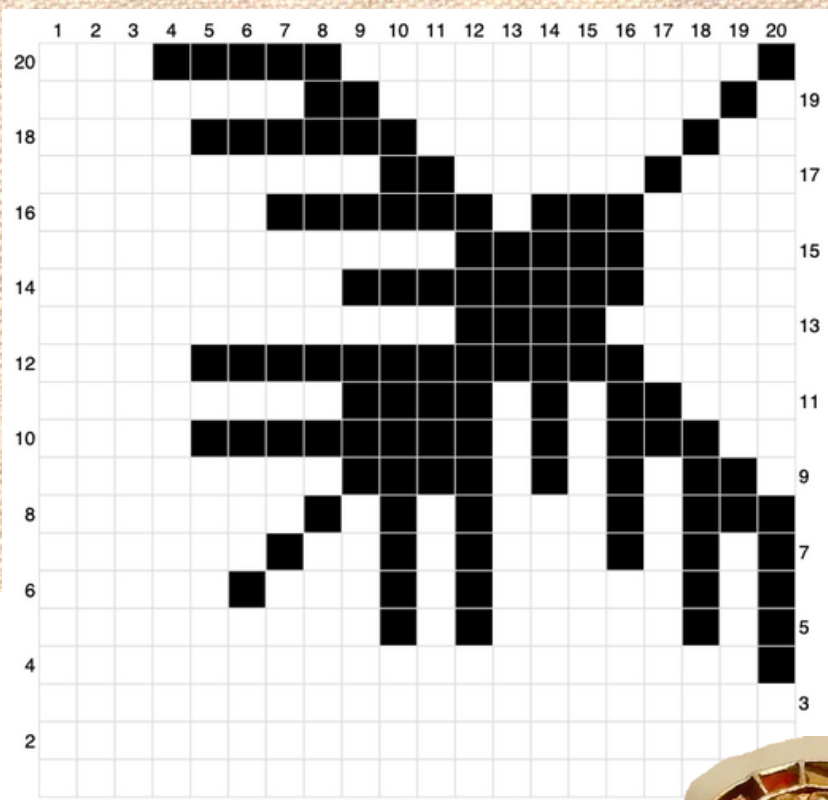
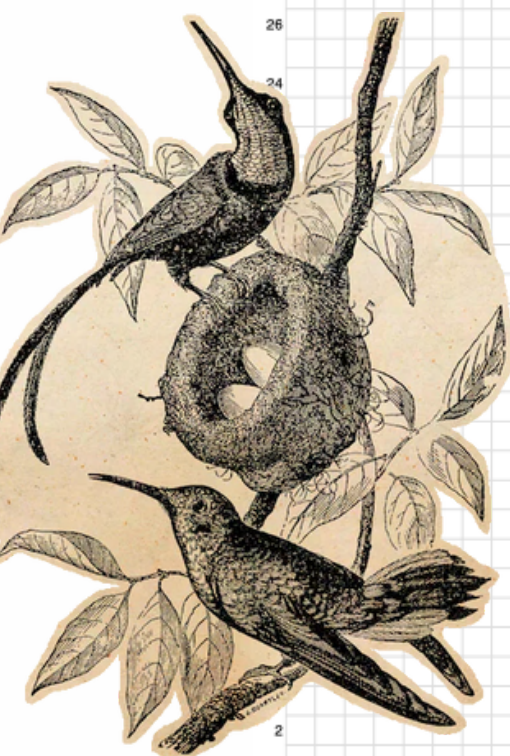
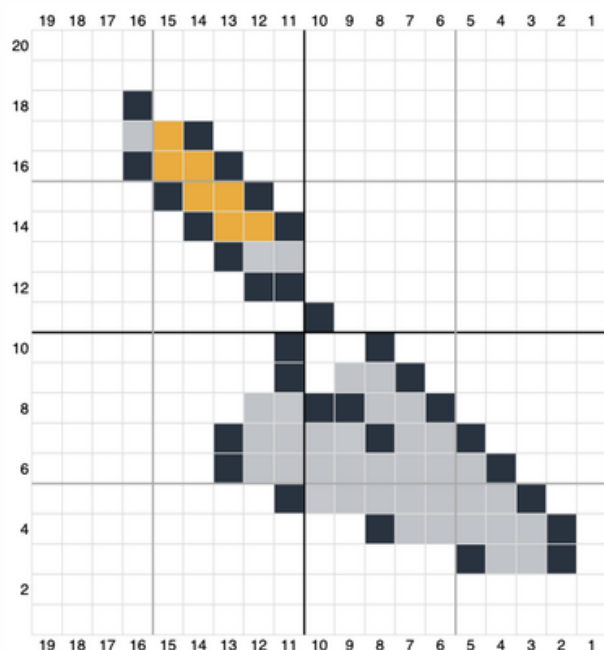
The main implication of scapes is subjectivity. The scape is a product of phenomenology, thinking about subjective experiences of the objective world. Subjectively causes an issue because scape indicates an universal experience or understanding of the word, which following the ontological turn we can now see this cannot be the case. If the word can be experienced or understood in multiple ways, the application of a scape doesn't reflect this multivocality. Using the sense scapes as an example, sound and smell are both temporary and invisible throughout a given space but between individuals are experienced very distinctively. For example, the smell of roses can be attached to different memories between different people invoking different emotions, hence form different experiences in that moment.

The other implication I would like to highlight is the lack of relationality of scapes. While the addition of a scape almost automatically relates in the landscape there is little thought into thinking how different scapes interact. People and things would be situated in a multitude of scapes at any given point where the intersection and relationship of these scapes would be constituting the lived experience rather than the separate experience of each scape at a time- a scapescape if you will. Furthermore, each scape is not static there is never a spatial or temporal fixed point. As such, the relations between scapes are dynamic and fluid.

Therefore, scapes are an oversimplification of what is really happening. Land, tasks, sound, smell, death, childhood, heritage, tin and bogs are never experienced or understood universally or in isolation. I argue that we should look beyond the scape to come up with more interesting and well-thought ideas of how a particular concept, material or action could have been understood and experienced in the past. From this we will be able to construct a more nuanced and complex comprehension of the past, where more interesting questions can arise.

Crochet/cross stitch patterns !!

Submitted by Malaika SB
- inspired by the
tapestry crochet
technique (Pinterest
it!), Mal has produced
patterns for a Nazca
hummingbird, a trowel,
and the Trumpington
Cross. Send in photos
if you make any of
these



FROM THE COMMITTEE

Hannah (Vice President)

3rd year so far has been ominously uneventful... Between my 4 supervisions & arduous Cornish tinscapes hillfort research, this term I've had time to attend 2 conferences with Izzy (see below) as well as help throw together various events for the AFC. A highlight has to be getting trapped in the Cyril Fox exhibition with no signal as Simon wrested with an automatic door.

Evan (Secretary)

This term has been a productive one for the society and it's been really fun to be part of the committee! It was especially great to welcome loads of new members in October and it was nice to top it all off with our end of term pub trip. I've particularly enjoyed helping out with our socials, with the pumpkin carving Halloween social probably my favourite of the term! One of the main things I've focused on this term has been trying to get our football team up and running. Our Friday afternoon kickabouts have been great fun and we've gathered more people as the term has gone on. It was nice to round off all our training with a great match against the ASNACs and more matches will follow next term, hopefully against some of our lecturers! I'm also particularly keen to get more first years involved since the current time clashes with A2 practicals- if any first years are particularly keen to join, shoot me a message! More generally I've really enjoyed the term and second year has been a blast so far- fingers crossed that everything doesn't go downhill in Lent (the AFC certainly won't!).

Alasdair (Treasurer)

Michaelmas has drawn to a close, which is shame, since, all things considered, it was a pretty good term. Seminars have provided plenty of places for good chats, and have been the springboard for many an interesting evening. Explorations in prehistoric food have yet to thoroughly disgruntle my corridor. As concerns the AFC, I have been unfairly prevented from putting the accounts into Babylonian, and am instead content that they balance. The film and crochet evening appealed to my urge to make things with wool.

Izzy (Publicity & Stash Officer)

This Michaelmas, my role has focused on creating some new designs for our AFC merchandise, as well as designing posts for our social media, which has been a great opportunity to spend time being creative this term! Otherwise, I've been busy this term planning for my dissertation, and also had the opportunity to go to two archaeology conferences - the Cyril Fox conference in Cambridge, and the Bronze Age Forum in Leicester.

Katja (Social Secretary)

It has been bittersweet to enter my last year at Cambridge, but it certainly hasn't been without the usual shenanigans. Overseeing the social events this term has allowed me to experience the joys of carrying about 8 pumpkins for Halloween into Fitz and juggling playing football behind Clare and rushing between seminars. Lest we forget the crochet/film night at Lucy where we had to fight the technology before being saved by porters. Apart from AFC duties I have really enjoyed the crushing fear of starting my dissertation and learning more about the Americas. Very excited to pull off some more events next term :)

Mia (President)

Since the takeover of the new committee last Easter, the University of Cambridge Archaeological Field Club has finally been revived since its sudden dark ages c. 2014-2021. To begin I would like to highlight the work of my predecessor Liam who began the effort in restoring the society to its former glory. During his term he successfully set up the AFC Seminar Series where we had the pleasure of receiving talks from academics, particular highlights being Prof. Ian Hodder and Prof. Chris Stringer. In this time our sister society CUBAS was also formed, allowing a space for bioanth-enthused students separate from our key archaeological focus. Despite these improvements there was still a long way for the AFC to go. Following my ascension to power in Lent 2023 I had formulated three goals that I wanted to achieve: 1. Bringing back the society's social focus, 2. Creating better relationships with the department and between different year groups, 3. De-bioanthing the AFC. With a strong and fully elected committee behind me, I can proudly say that at the end of Michaelmas 2023 we have achieved all of the goals we had set out to achieve.

The committee began working straight away in planning and preparing for the term ahead due to our limited timeframe before Easter term rolled around. Our first event was a talk from Prof. Marie Louise Sorenson about her work on the SAX project in Hungary, this allowed us to continue the beloved AFC Seminar Series in the archaeological direction we envisioned. Our pre-exam social was a classic AFC X ASNAC pub quiz swap at the Iris, where they challenged us to the first annual AFC vs ASNAC sports day. Unfortunately, we had met defeat in the first annual sports day, but our sporting defeat did not last forever as you will see later. We rounded out the 2022-23 academic year with our Uluburun Shipwrecked themed Garden Party: 'An Assemblage Under the Sea' at Magdalene College.

The long vacation gave us all at Cambridge a well needed time of peace and relaxation. This tranquillity, however, did not slow us at the AFC down as we built off the momentum of

Easter term. With a new crest and a dream we returned to Cambridge ready to energise the AFC once again. Hannah and I began term by introducing the AFC to the Part I and MPhil students which was a bit hit causing interest in the AFC to reach a new high. Our first event of term was our Fresher's Picnic enjoyed at Christ's Pieces where we all got to meet everyone for the first time altogether. Following this we set up the AFC Whatsapp chat to finally have an efficient way of correspondence between members, so no one missed any events. This was also joined with the return of archaeology families amongst undergrads to help out freshers adjusting to the department and allowing for better inter-year relations. The first speaker event of term was from Dr. Jody Joy who gave us an exclusive tour of his exhibition at the MMA. Then we had our first craft night of term at Halloween, where we did some archaeological pumpkin carving. Halloween time also marked the dawn of AFC United captained by Evan (Premier League contenders if I do say so myself), who on our debut match defeated the ASNACS 4-0 reminding them that we will not take our sports day loss lightly. Michaelmas term was beginning to come to a close, but the forthcoming end was not stopping the determination and ambition of the committee for organising some great events. Our second craft night was our film and crochet night where we filled Lucy Cav JCR to watch Night of the Museum while enjoying some relaxing crochet. Then we had our first stash drop of some archaeological themed stickers, all made by Izzy herself (please go to our Redbubble and grab them as a Christmas present before its too late!). Our second speaker Prof. Oliver Harris came down from Leicester to give a talk on current archaeological theory and its application for the future. Then at the end of week 8 we had an exclusive tour of the Cyril Fox exhibit from our Senior Treasurer Prof. Simon Stoddart, who then treated us to a round at the Pickerel officially signing off term.

Now as we begin preparing for Lent 2024, I would like to thank my committee (Evan, Alasdair, Katja and Izzy) for making this term possible with their ideas, organisation and support. With special thanks to my Vice President Hannah for organising the return of the Newsletter and being my constant second-hand man, and Prof. Simon Stoddart for always helping us out behind the scenes. I would also like to thank the department administrators and Dr. Tamsin O'Connell for their enthusiasm and support throughout term. I hope everyone has a great holiday and a well needed break from term. Don't forget to keep an eye on our social media for our Lent term card!